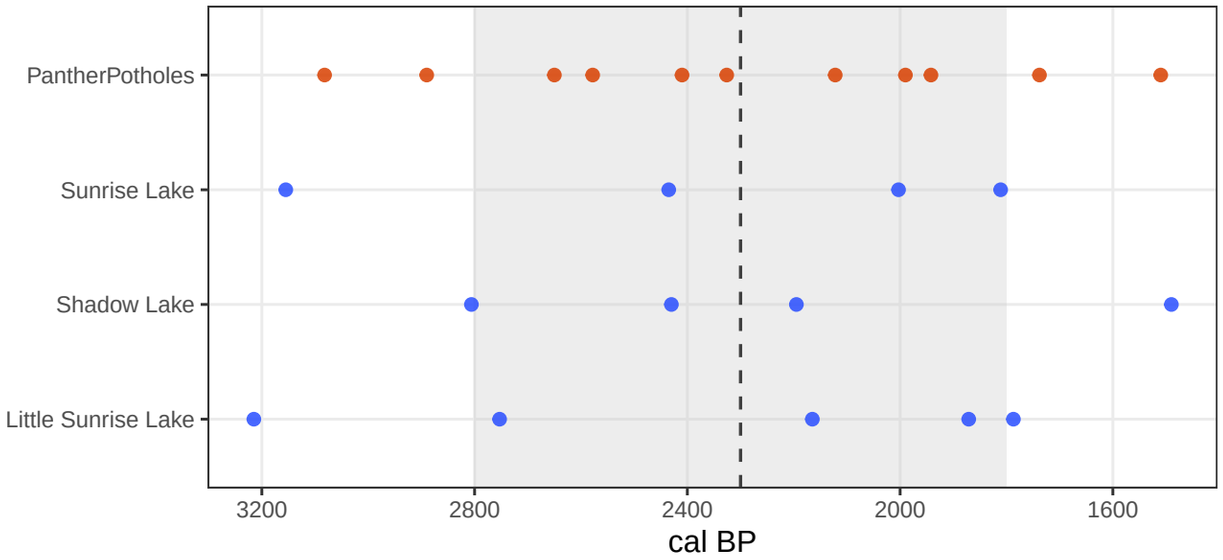
Worked example: Holocene high−fire classification at 2,300 cal BP

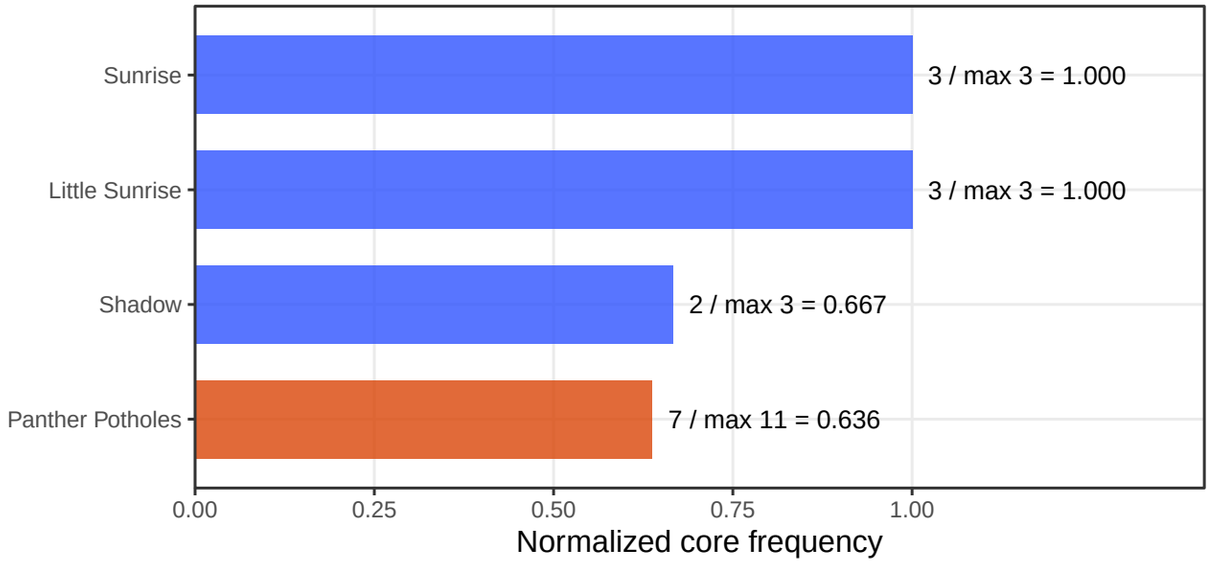
1 Select accepted events

Centered 1,000−year window: [1,800, 2,800) cal BP



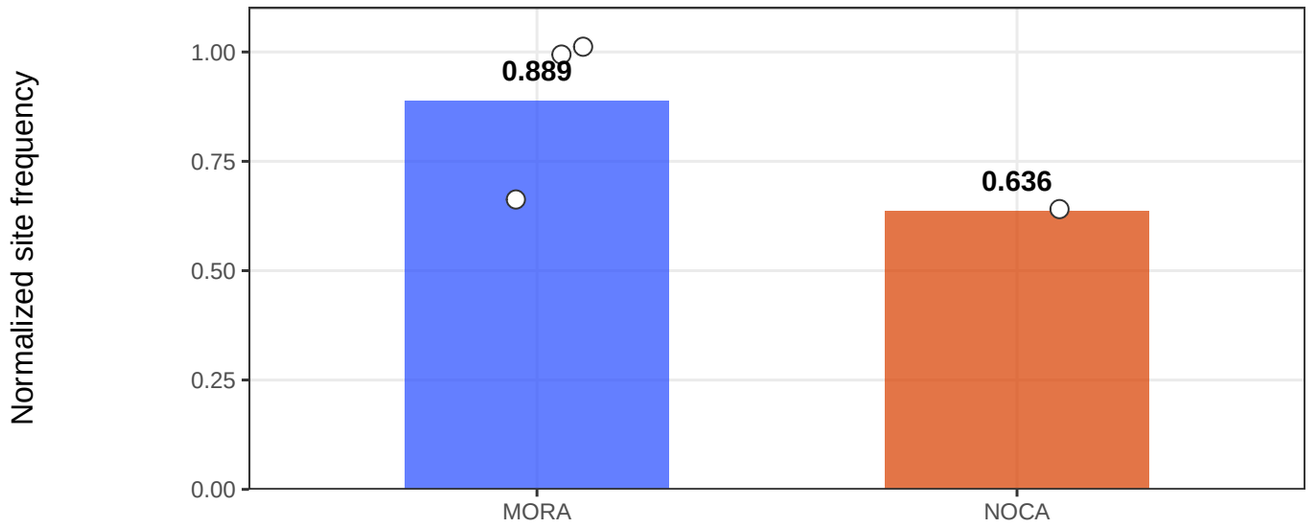
2 Normalize frequency within each core

normalized core frequency = 1,000−year count / core maximum



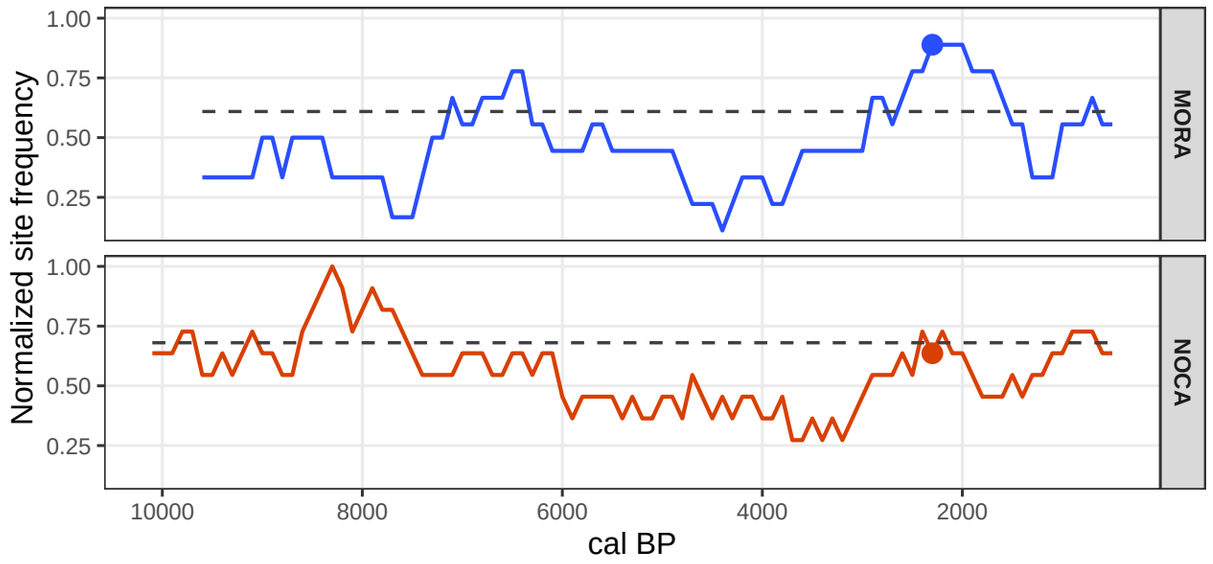
3 Form the site frequency

MORA = equal mean of covered cores; NOCA = local record



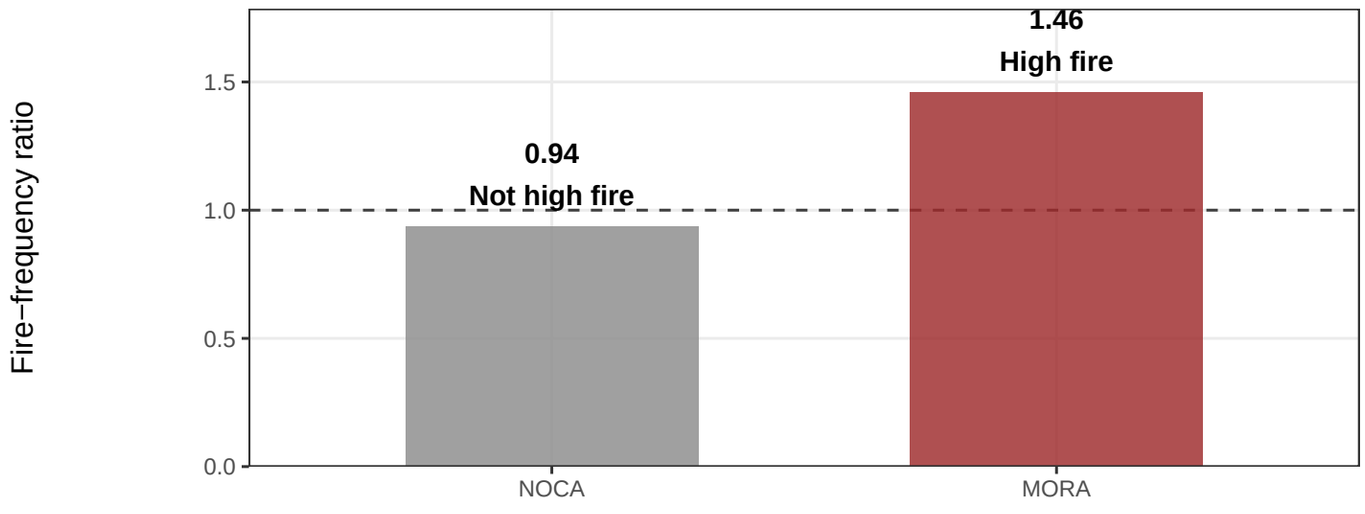
4 Calculate a robust site threshold

threshold = temporal median + 1.4826 × MAD



5 Classify the example date

fire−frequency ratio = site frequency / site threshold



6 Interpret without changing the rule

MORA: mean(1.000, 1.000, 0.667) = 0.889
threshold = 0.444 + 0.165 = 0.609
ratio = 1.46 −> HIGH FIRE

NOCA: Panther Potholes = 0.636
threshold = 0.545 + 0.135 = 0.680
ratio = 0.94 −> not high fire

Peak strength and background CHAR can corroborate, but cannot create a high−fire classification.